

Cybersecurity for SME Employees

Module 2.3 – Device & Endpoint Security

1 Objective

Educate employees on how to protect their devices (laptops, phones, desktops) from cyber threats in the workplace.

2 Introduction

In today's work environment, every device connected to the internet is a potential entry point for attackers. Endpoint security involves protecting these devices against malware, unauthorized access, and misuse. In this module, employees will learn how to secure their work devices and prevent common endpoint threats.

3 Why Device Security Matters

- Devices are often the first targets in an attack.
- Compromised devices can leak sensitive company data.
- A single infected machine can compromise the whole network.

4 Core Concepts of Endpoint Security

4.1 1. Use Antivirus and Anti-Malware Tools

- Install reputable antivirus software on all company devices.
- Enable real-time protection and schedule regular scans.
- Keep the antivirus up to date to catch the latest threats.

4.2 2. Keep Operating Systems and Software Updated

- Always install system and application updates.
- Patches fix security flaws that hackers exploit.
- Enable auto-updates wherever possible.

4.3 3. Avoid Unauthorized Software and Apps

- Do not install apps unless approved by IT.
- Unknown software can introduce malware or spyware.
- Follow company policies for software use.

4.4 4. Secure Use of USB Drives and External Devices

- USBs can carry malware between systems.
- Never plug in unknown or found USB devices.
- Use encrypted drives for sensitive data.

4.5 5. Bluetooth and Peripheral Security

- Turn off Bluetooth when not in use.
- Only pair with trusted, verified devices.
- Avoid using public or shared keyboards/mice.

5 Secure Configuration Practices

- Enable full-disk encryption on laptops.
- Use strong login passwords or biometrics.
- Lock your screen when away from your desk.
- Disable unnecessary services or ports.

6 Example Scenario

An employee brings a personal USB drive from home and plugs it into a work laptop. The drive contains a hidden trojan that installs a keylogger. Over time, sensitive credentials are stolen and sold on the dark web. This breach could have been avoided by following proper device security policies.

7 Conclusion

Devices are both tools and targets. Keeping endpoints secure through antivirus tools, regular updates, safe USB practices, and cautious app usage plays a huge role in organizational cybersecurity. In the next module, we'll explore how to securely work over Wi-Fi and in remote environments.